> autonomy within the British Commonwealth, with transitory provisions for bringing the whole constitution into full operation within the time specified by the Congress and the Moslem League.
>
> The autonomy we advocate may be briefly sketched as follows: The Peninsula of India should be divided into a number of provinces on the principle of nationality. The Province should administer the internal affairs of the Province and be entrusted with all powers requisite for the administration. The form of government should be democratic. These Provinces should be federated to form the United States of India, with democratic Central Executive and Legislative bodies having powers to deal with the internal affairs of the whole of India. The United States of India should form a unit of the British Commonwealth with equal status with any other constituent thereof... [emphases added].

The purpose of placing Rai's pamphlet before the readers in the context of the discussion at hand was to show that in 1919, that is, after close to 84 years of introduction of Macaulay's education policy, the awareness of Bharat's civilisational character and history was still alive, which brings Rai's position closer to that of historians of his time, such as Radhakumud Mookerji, and others. Importantly, Rai drew attention to the existence of democratic and republican institutions in Bharat much before the arrival of both the Middle Eastern and European colonisers. As one of the leading lights of the Home Rule Movement, Rai's distinction between Bharat as a civilisation and Europe's construct of a nation indicates that at least until 1919, those who fought for this country's decolonisation, even if gradual, were aware of its roots and had not been fully colonialised. While this may point to the inherent strength of the Indic civilisation, colonial education and its version of Bharat's history had started showing results, evident from the references to the 'Aryan race' and 'caste' in Rai's pamphlet. Therefore, a certain degree of duality had begun to surface in Bharat's indigenous consciousness, at least by 1919.

In any case, despite such representations for self-government, albeit within the British Empire, the Government of India Act of 1919 was enacted, which was based on the idea of 'responsible government', evident from its Preamble that read as follows: